

	Indian Society for Training and Development Student Chapter		
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Report on – “Beyond Books : The Psychology Of Success”

Date: 8th November, 2025

Time: 7.00pm – 8.00pm

Event Overview:

On 8th November 2025, the ISTD Chennai Chapter, in collaboration with Sri Venkateswara College of Engineering, organized an engaging webinar titled “**Beyond Books: The Psychology of Success.**” The session stood out for its focus on aspects of growth that often go unnoticed in traditional academic settings. Rather than concentrating solely on grades or technical knowledge, the webinar encouraged students to look inward and understand the psychological foundations. The session was led by **Ms. P. Cokilavani**, M.Sc Psychology, PGDGC, a specialist in career development and mental health. Drawing from her professional experience, she spoke about the importance of mindset, motivation, emotional balance, and self-awareness in both personal and professional life.

Through relatable examples and reflective insights, she guided students to understand how managing stress, resilience, and maintaining a healthy mindset can positively influence decision-making and career growth. The session helped participants see how psychological strength complements academic learning, enabling them to perform better not just in their studies, but in life beyond college. By the end of the webinar, students gained a deeper understanding of themselves and felt better to handle challenges with confidence and balance. The session went beyond motivation—it offered meaningful tools for self-development, making it a valuable and enriching experience for all who attended.

Session Insights – Ms. P. Cokilavani M.Sc Psychology , PGDGC:

Ms. P. Cokilavani delivered a **highly engaging and insightful session** that focused on the **psychological foundations of success, emotional well-being, and personal growth**. She emphasized the importance of **focus**, encouraging students to maintain clarity, avoid distractions, and direct their energy toward meaningful goals. She highlighted how **supportive friendships act as emotional fuel**, strengthening motivation and mental stability. She explained that true fulfillment comes from **self-awareness, personal values, and purposeful living**, while **emotional balance** is essential for academic excellence and overall success.

Ms. Cokilavani stressed the need for a **growth mindset**, urging students to embrace challenges, stay motivated, and learn continuously. She described **career development** as a gradual journey of **self-discovery, skill-building, and continuous growth**, rather than merely securing a job. Introducing the **Johari Window**, she explained self-awareness through the **Arena, Blind Spot, Facade, and Unknown**, encouraging students to **expand their openness**.

She illustrated the **motivation cycle** using a simple example, showing how needs evolve into drive, behavior, achievement, and new goals. She emphasized setting **SMART goals (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound)** to stay organized and track progress. She also shared practical tips such as **progress over perfection**, daily learning, staying around positive people, and renewing motivation regularly.

A major part of the session focused on **mental health awareness**, where she explained **depression** with signs like lack of interest, fatigue, negative thoughts, sleep issues, and appetite changes, emphasizing that it is **real, common, and treatable**. She addressed **stress and anxiety**, discussing symptoms such as overthinking, restlessness, fast heartbeat, headaches, and withdrawal. To help students manage these issues, she introduced the **Circle of Control, Influence, and Concern**.

She concluded with practical coping strategies including **talking to someone, physical activity, good sleep, mindfulness, avoiding comparisons, and seeking professional help** when needed.

Participant Experience:

Students actively participated throughout the session, engaging in discussions and reflections that made the webinar highly interactive and impactful. Many participants resonated strongly with the real-life examples shared by the speaker, which helped them connect psychological concepts to their own academic pressures, emotional challenges, and career uncertainties. The clarity and simplicity with which complex ideas were explained made the session accessible and meaningful for students from diverse backgrounds.

Participants expressed that the session helped them gain a better understanding of their own emotions, stress triggers, and thought patterns, enabling them to view challenges with a more balanced and positive mindset. Several students felt reassured knowing that struggles such as self-doubt, lack of motivation, and anxiety are common and manageable when approached with the right psychological tools. The supportive tone of the session created a safe space for reflection, encouraging students to think deeply about personal growth beyond academic performance.

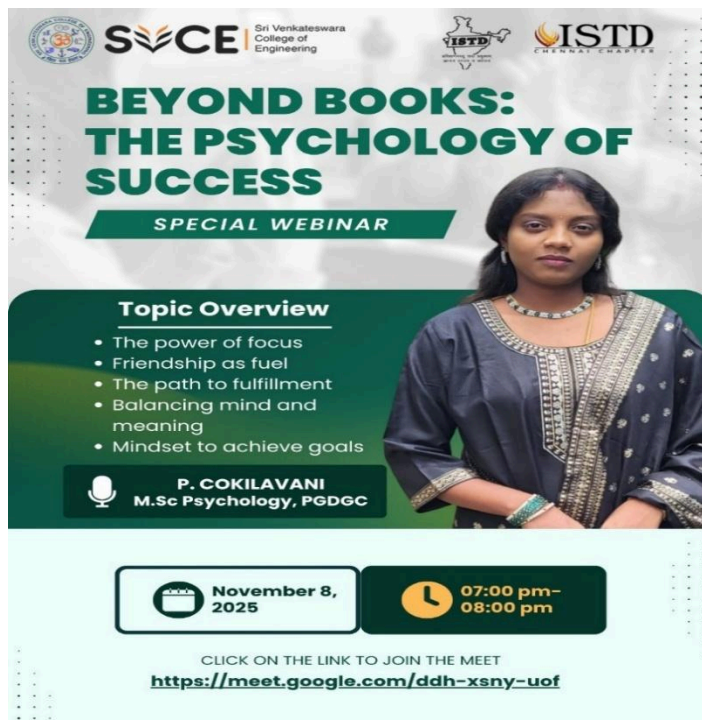
Overall, the webinar was described as enlightening, motivational, and emotionally engaging. Students found it highly relevant to both their academic journey and personal development, leaving them with a sense of clarity, confidence, and renewed motivation to approach their goals with resilience and self-awareness.

Conclusion:

The webinar **“Beyond Books: The Psychology of Success”** created a lasting impact by encouraging students to rethink their understanding of success beyond academic achievements and technical skills. What made this session truly meaningful was its emphasis on the internal factors that shape long-term growth—mindset, emotional intelligence, self-awareness, and psychological resilience.

One of the strongest outcomes of the session was the clarity it provided on the role psychology plays in everyday student life. Through thoughtful explanations and relatable examples, Ms. P. Cokilavani helped students recognize how emotions, thought patterns, and mental well-being influence performance, decision-making, and confidence. This shift in perspective allowed participants to understand that success is not solely determined by external achievements. Another significant takeaway was the emphasis on continuous self-growth. Just as careers evolve, so do personal challenges, and the session reinforced the idea that mental well-being requires ongoing attention and effort. Students were encouraged to remain self-aware, adaptable, and emotionally grounded as they move forward in their careers. This message resonated strongly, as it validated their experiences while providing realistic guidance for navigating future pressures.

In conclusion, **“Beyond Books: The Psychology of Success”** was not merely an informative webinar, but a transformative experience that encouraged reflection, fostered emotional awareness, and laid a strong foundation for lifelong personal development. The insights shared during the session will continue to guide participants as they navigate academic challenges and future careers, making this event a meaningful step toward holistic success.



The brochure features logos for SVCE (Sri Venkateswara College of Engineering) and ISTD (International Student Teachers' Development) at the top. The title "BEYOND BOOKS: THE PSYCHOLOGY OF SUCCESS" is prominently displayed in green, with "SPECIAL WEBINAR" below it. A photo of Ms. P. Cokilavani is on the right. The "Topic Overview" section lists five bullet points: "The power of focus", "Friendship as fuel", "The path to fulfillment", "Balancing mind and meaning", and "Mindset to achieve goals". Below this, a microphone icon precedes the speaker's name "P. COKILAVANI" and her credentials "M.Sc Psychology, PGDGC". At the bottom, a calendar icon indicates the date "November 8, 2025", and a clock icon shows the time "07:00 pm - 08:00 pm". A link to join the meeting is provided: "https://meet.google.com/ddh-xsny-uof".

**BEYOND BOOKS:
THE PSYCHOLOGY OF
SUCCESS**

SPECIAL WEBINAR

Topic Overview

- The power of focus
- Friendship as fuel
- The path to fulfillment
- Balancing mind and meaning
- Mindset to achieve goals

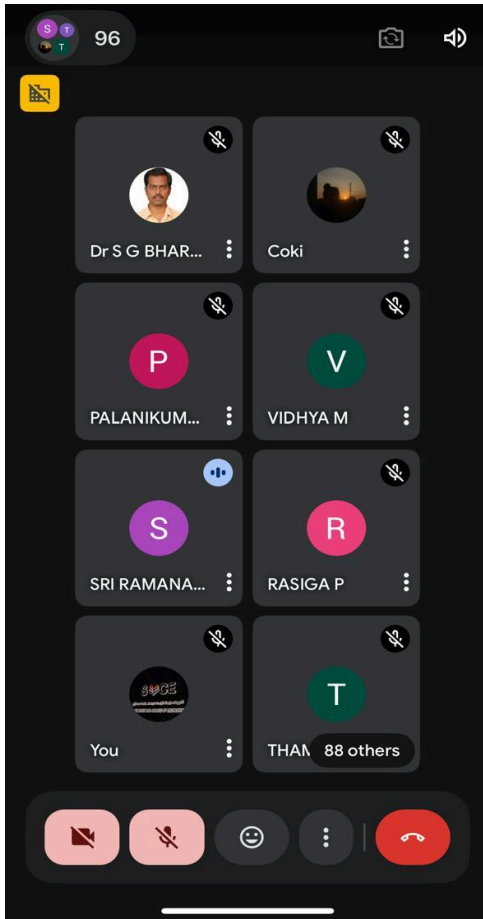
P. COKILAVANI
M.Sc Psychology, PGDGC

**November 8,
2025**

**07:00 pm -
08:00 pm**

CLICK ON THE LINK TO JOIN THE MEET
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Photographs:



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